Assignment 3.2
After watching the episode of John Berger's ideas in Ways of Seeing. I began thinking how much modern life is connected to possessions, money, and the way we want other people to see us. Berger explains to us how oil paintings were often used to show wealth, status, property, and success. Even though we are in a different time period, I believe the same idea still exists today through social media, advertising, and publicity.
I see this a lot on social media like Instagram and tiktok. People post pictures of expensive cars, designer clothes, vacations, nice homes, jewelry, and expensive meals. Sometimes the purpose is not just to share an experience, but to show other people what they have and what kind of life they can afford. Kind of similar to the oil paintings Berger discussed. Instead of having a painting showing someone's possessions, we now have pictures and videos showing them.

I also feel that ~~others~~ advertisements encourage us to believe that buying stuff will make us happier. or make our lives better. Everyday we see influencers promoting makeup, clothes, weight loss products, cars, and other things, and we are encouraged to believe that owning these things will help us become a better or more successful version of ourselves.

I don't necessarily believe that possessions are automatically bad. I myself like many people enjoy having things that make me feel confident or help make my life easier. But I do think there is a huge difference between enjoying something and believing that our possessions determine our worth. Modern visual culture can make it easy to compare ourselves to other people and feel lilhe we are not doing enough.

After reading about Berger's ideas, I believe we are still living under many of these ideas today. The only difference today is that we don't use oil paintings to display wealth and status, we use digital

images, social media, advertisements, and publicity. What we consume visually can influence what we believe success and happiness should look like.